Sail la Vie

USER GUIDE

Log your sails, keep your crew and boats together,
plan the next trip and share it with friends.

Updated October 2026 · Android and iPhone



All names, boats, photos and sails in this guide are made-up examples.

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What’s new in this edition: the automatic **Weather on the water** report on your sail pages (section 8), sharing **Noticeboard plans** with friends (sections 13 and 15), and your profile, cover, boat and crew photos are now backed up and kept in sync on all your devices, just like your sail photos.

SECTION 1

Installing Sail la Vie

Sail la Vie runs on Android phones and tablets as an installed app, and on iPhone as a web app you add to your home screen. Either way it opens full screen from its own icon, just like any other app.

On Android (recommended: the installed app)

During testing the Android app isn't in the Play Store yet, so it comes as an app file (an **.apk**) that you download from the link you were sent.

1. On your phone, tap the **Sail la Vie download link**. If Chrome warns that the file could be harmful, tap **Download anyway** (it only says this because the app isn't from the Play Store). When it finishes, tap it (or find it in **Files → Downloads**).
2. The first time, Android asks for permission to **install unknown apps**. Tap **Settings**, turn on **Allow from this source** for the app you downloaded it with (usually Chrome), then go back.
3. Tap **Install**. If Google Play Protect warns that the app is from an unknown developer, tap **More details → Install anyway**. This is normal for test apps that don't come from the Play Store.
4. Tap **Open**. The Sail la Vie icon is now in your app drawer; press and hold it to add it to your home screen.
5. When the app asks, allow **Location → While using the app** (recording still keeps going with the screen off) and **Notifications** (for Noticeboard reminders).

Updating: when there's a new version, the app shows an **Update available** message when you open it. Tap **Download**, open the file and tap **Install**. It installs over the old one, and your sails, boats and crew are kept. You can also get the latest version any time from **Settings → Help & About → About → Download for Android**. Your version number is at the bottom of **Settings**.

On iPhone (web app)

On iPhone, Sail la Vie runs from Safari and is saved to your home screen. It has to be **Safari**: other browsers on iPhone can't add it properly.

1. Open **Safari** and go to **petejackson141.github.io/sail-la-vie** (or tap the link you were sent).
2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow pointing up) at the bottom of the screen.
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**. Leave the name as "Sail la Vie" and tap **Add**.
4. Close Safari and open Sail la Vie from the new icon on your home screen. From now on, always open it from the icon.
5. When it asks for your location, tap **Allow**. See section 18 for how to keep tracking going on iPhone.

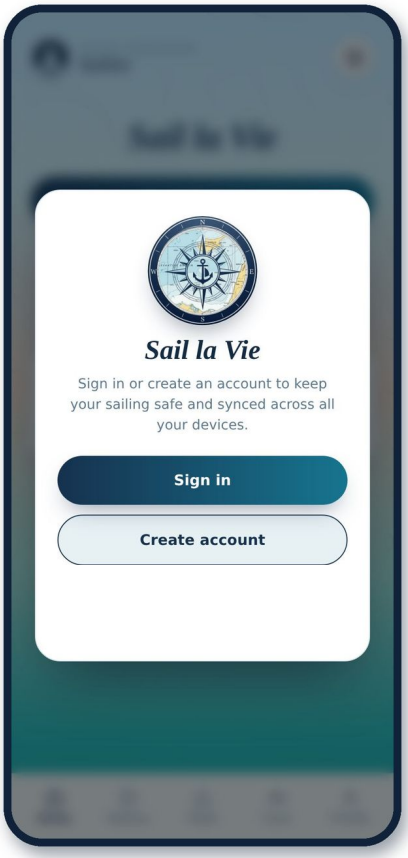
Updating: the iPhone version updates itself. Close the app completely (swipe it away) and open it again to get the latest version.

> **Good to know:** Android tablets and iPads work too, installed the same way. On Android you can also use the web version (Chrome → ⋮ → **Add to Home screen**), but it only tracks while the screen is on.

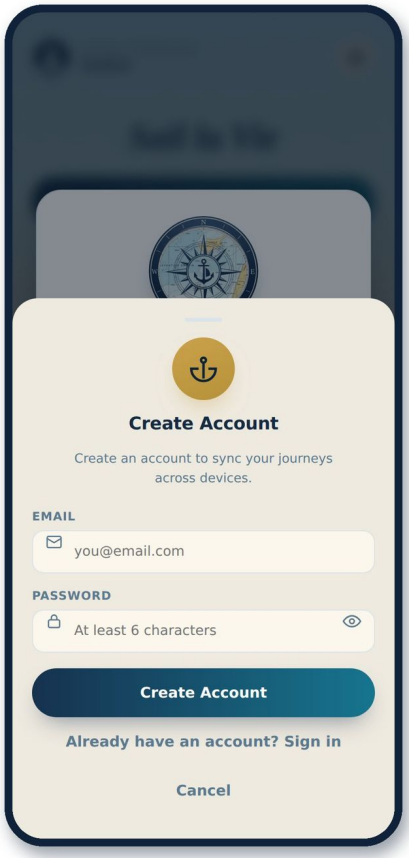
SECTION 2

Getting started

When you open Sail la Vie for the first time you're asked to sign in or create an account. An account backs up your sails, boats, crew and plans to the cloud, keeps them in sync across your devices, and lets you add friends.



Welcome screen



Create an account

Create your account

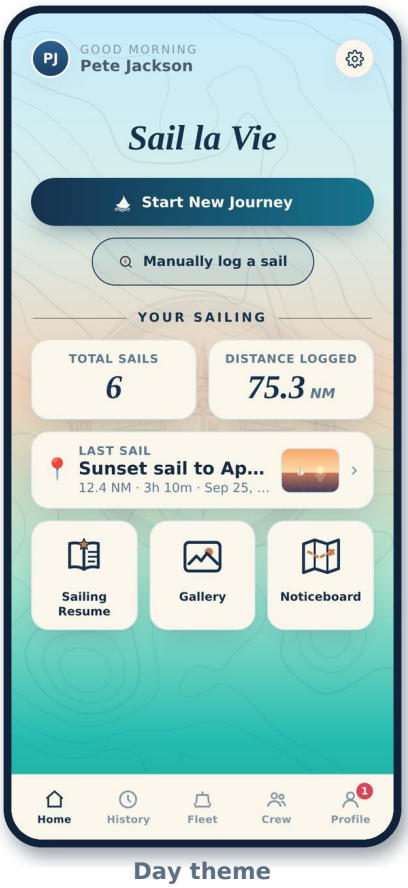
1. Tap **Create account**.
2. Enter your email and a password (at least 6 characters). The eye icon shows the password so you can check it.
3. Tap **Create Account**. If a confirmation email arrives, tap the link in it: on Android it opens straight back in the app, already signed in.
4. **Choose your username.** Letters, numbers and spaces are fine, for example "Pete Jackson". It's how other sailors find you. During testing, your username, name and photo can be seen by everyone using the app; your sails stay private unless you share them.
5. Already have an account? Tap **Sign in** instead.

> **Tip:** Everything you log is saved on your phone first, so the app works at sea with no signal. It syncs with the cloud automatically the next time you're online.

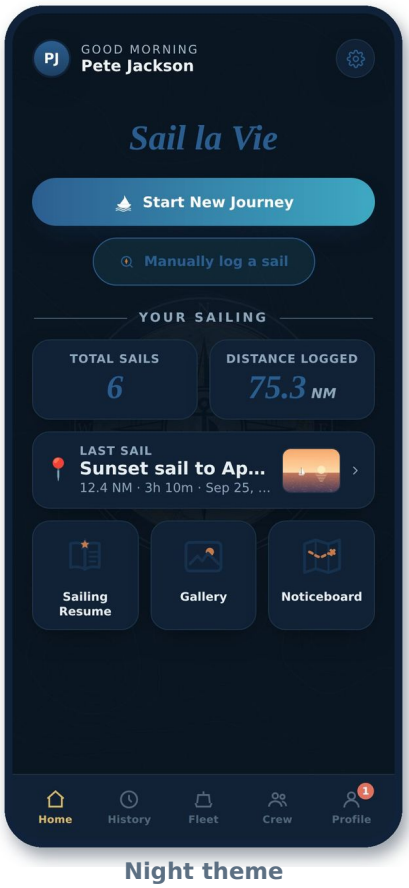
SECTION 3

The Home screen

Home is your starting point. It greets you, shows your totals and your most recent sail, and has shortcuts to everything else.



Day theme



Night theme

What’s on it

Start New Journey records a sail live with GPS. **Manually log a sail** is for a sail you’ve already done. Under **Your Sailing** you’ll see your total sails and distance, then a **Last Sail** card (tap it to open that sail). The three tiles open your **Sailing Resume**, the **Gallery** of all your photos and the **Noticeboard** of planned sails.

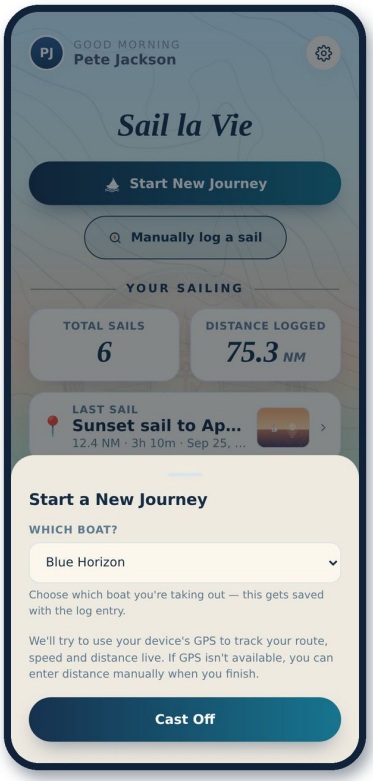
Tap your photo at the top left to go to your Profile, or the gear at the top right for Settings. The bar at the bottom is always there: **Home**, **History**, **Fleet**, **Crew** and **Profile**. A small red number on Profile means you have a new friend request.

On Android, the phone’s **back button** (or back gesture) takes you back one screen, closes an open panel or photo, and only leaves the app from Home.

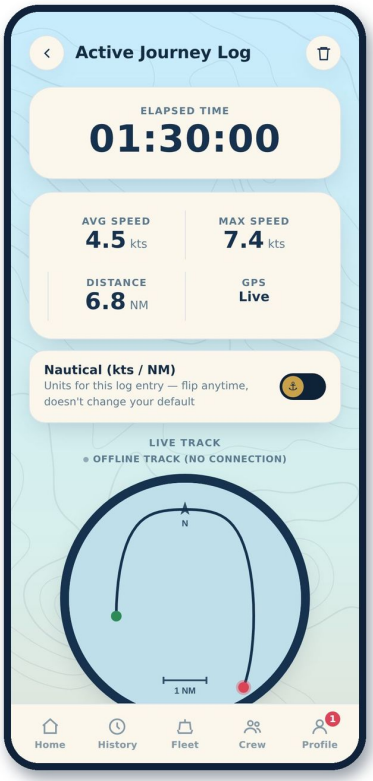
SECTION 4

Recording a sail live

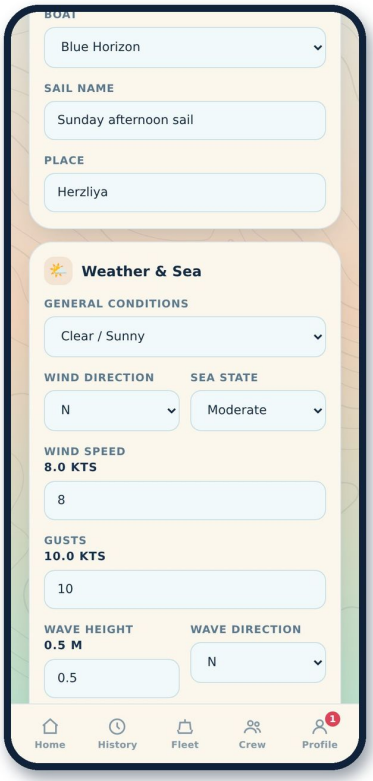
Use this when you’re about to leave. The app tracks your route with GPS and times the sail, while you fill in the details as you go.



Choose your boat



Live tracking



Details & weather

Step by step

1. On Home, tap **Start New Journey**, choose the boat you’re taking out, then tap **Cast Off**.
2. The log screen shows the elapsed time, average and max speed, distance and GPS status, with a live map of your route. The weather is filled in for you when you cast off, and you can change it.
3. Scroll down to add a title, the place, the weather and sea state, your skipper and crew, photos and notes.
4. When you’re back, tap **End Journey** at the bottom and confirm. If you added photos, pick one as the cover, then choose who can see the sail (section 7).

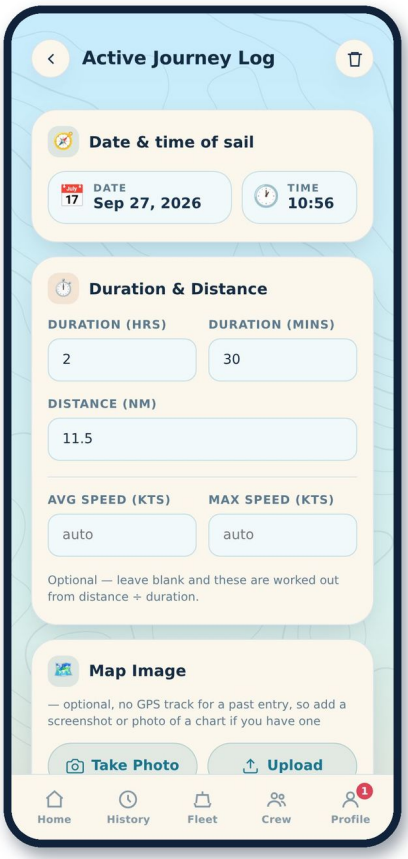
Tip: You can leave the log screen while sailing: the journey keeps recording and a red “Recording” banner above the bottom bar takes you back to it. The bin icon at the top discards the journey.

Units and maps: The switch on the log screen flips between nautical (knots and NM) and metric units for this sail only. With a signal, the live map shows the coastline; offline, the track is still drawn on a simple chart.

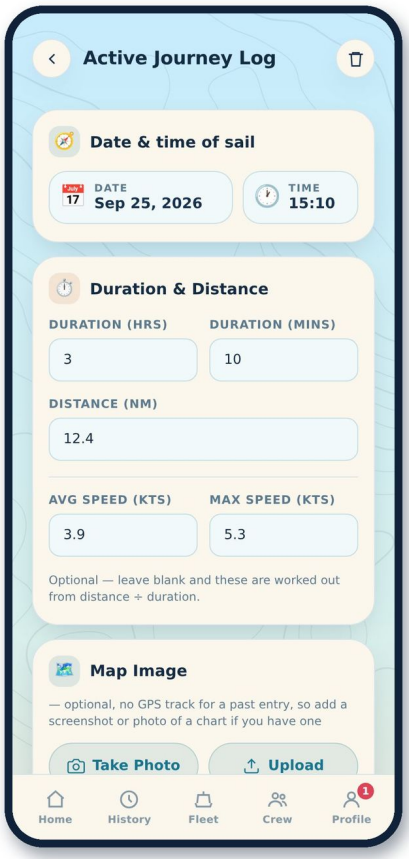
SECTION 5

Logging a past sail

Forgot to start tracking, or entering old sails from a paper logbook? Log them by hand.



Past sail form



Editing a saved sail

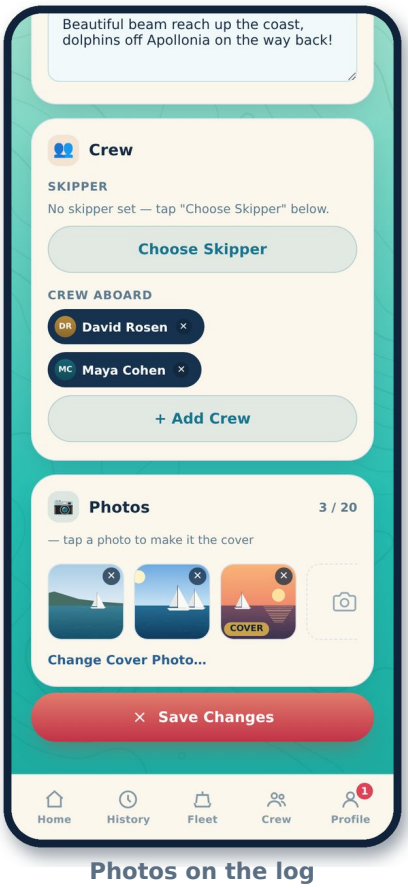
1. On Home, tap **Manually log a sail**.
2. Set the **date and time**, then the **duration** and **distance**. Average and max speed are optional: leave them blank and the app works them out.
3. Optionally add a **map image** (a photo of a chart or a screenshot of your route), then the same details as a live sail: title, boat, place, weather, crew, photos and notes.
4. Tap **Save Log Entry**.

The same form is used to **edit** any saved sail: open it and tap the pencil at the top.

SECTION 6

Photos on your sails

Add photos while you're sailing or afterwards. They're saved to the sail, backed up to the cloud and shown in the Gallery.



Photos on the log

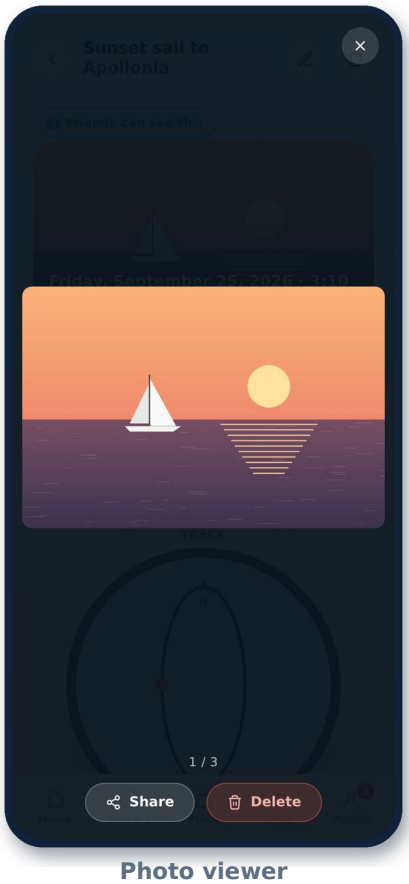


Photo viewer

Adding photos

In the **Photos** section of the log, tap the camera to take a picture or choose from your phone. The counter shows how many you've added: each sail can hold up to **20 photos**. Tap a photo to make it the cover, or use **Change Cover Photo…** to pick and crop it. The small **×** removes a photo.

Photos are made smaller automatically so they upload quickly, while still looking sharp on your phone and in PDFs. They're saved on your phone first (so adding them works at sea) and uploaded to your account when you're back online.

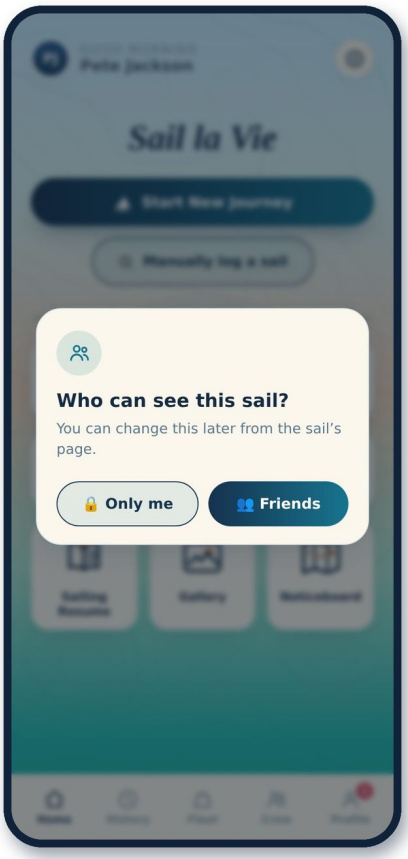
Viewing photos

Tap any photo on a sail's page or in the Gallery to open it full screen. **Swipe** left or right to move between photos, **pinch** or **double-tap** to zoom in, and use **Share** to send it or **Delete** to remove it (you're asked to confirm). Tap **×** or use the back button to close it.

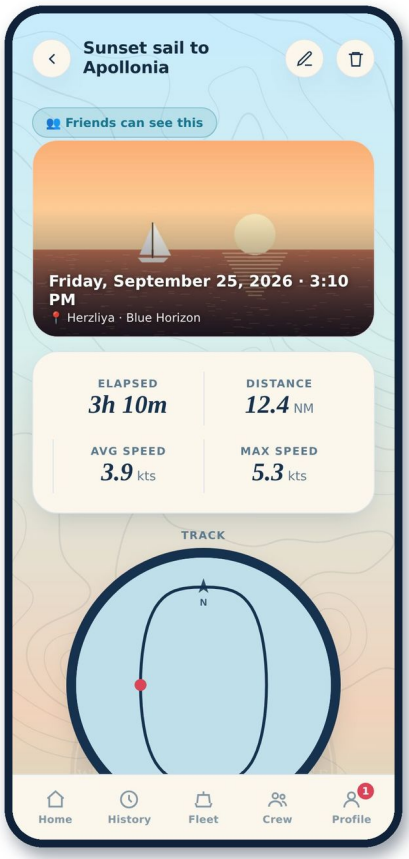
SECTION 7

Who can see your sail

Your sails are private unless you choose to share them. Every time you save a new sail while signed in, the app asks who should be able to see it.



Asked when you save



Change it any time

Only me keeps the sail private. **Friends** lets the people you've added as friends see it on your page (section 15). Tapping outside the question counts as Only me.

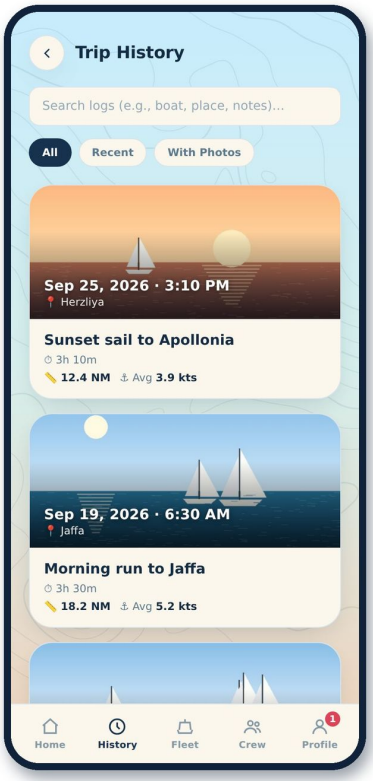
To change it later, open the sail and tap the small chip at the top: **Only me** or **Friends can see this**. Each tap switches between the two.

> **Tip:** Sails you logged before friends existed all start as Only me, so nothing is ever shared by surprise.

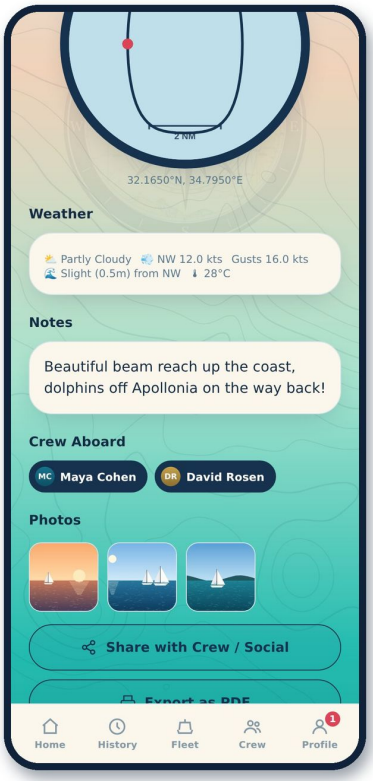
SECTION 8 · UPDATED

Trip History and your sail pages

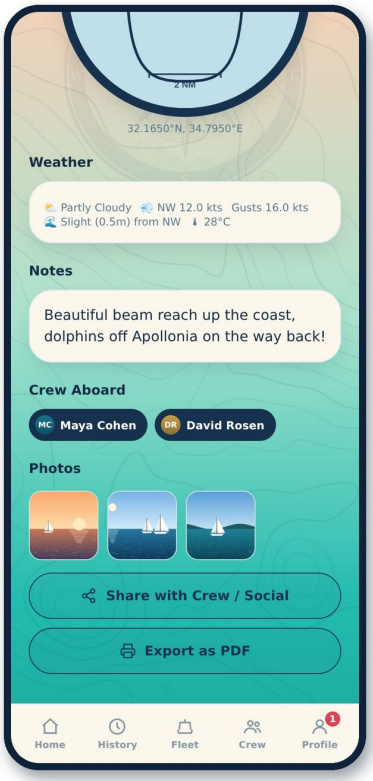
History lists every sail you've logged, newest first. Tap one to open its full page.



Trip History



Track & weather



Crew, photos, sharing

Finding a sail

Type in the search box to find sails by boat, place or notes, or use the chips: **All**, **Recent** or **With Photos**.

On a sail's page

You'll see the cover photo, date, place and boat, the time, distance and speeds, a map of your track, the weather, notes, skipper and crew aboard, and all the photos. When you're online the map shows real charts: tap the map style button to switch between **Minimal**, **Nautical** and **Colorful** (the app remembers your choice).

At the bottom, **Share with Crew / Social** sends a short text summary, and **Export as PDF** makes a printable log (section 9). The pencil edits the sail and the bin deletes it.

Weather on the water

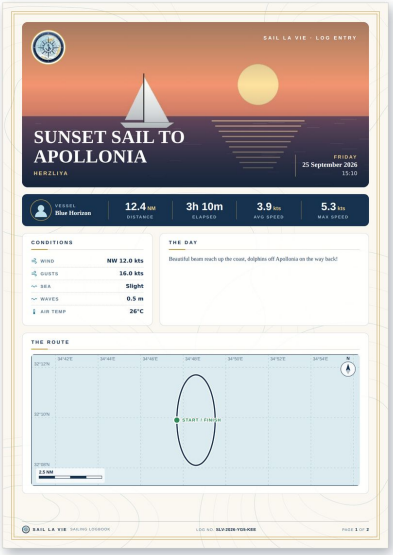
Sails recorded with GPS get an automatic weather report. As soon as you're online, the app looks up the wind, gusts, wind direction, pressure, waves and temperature along your track, hour by hour, and shows a short summary, a wind chart and the highs and lows. The weather you logged when you cast off stays as it was.

The report comes from weather forecasts, not instruments on your boat, so tap **Add your own observations** to note what you actually saw. Sails recorded before this feature show a **Get weather report** button instead. Friends see the report on sails you share.

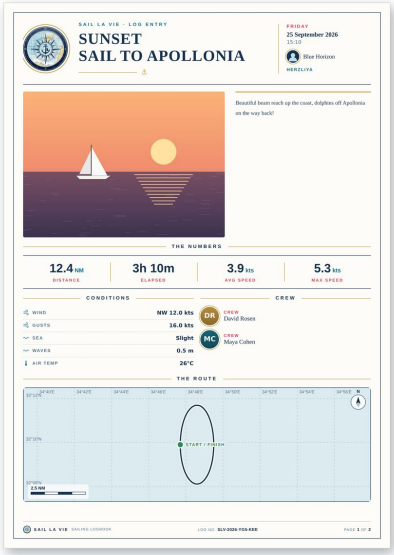
SECTION 9

Exporting a sail as a PDF

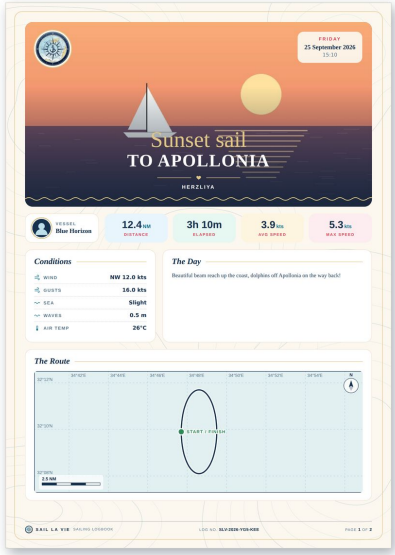
Turn any sail into a smart A4 log page you can print, keep or share, with the photos, conditions, crew and a chart of your route.



Nautical Magazine



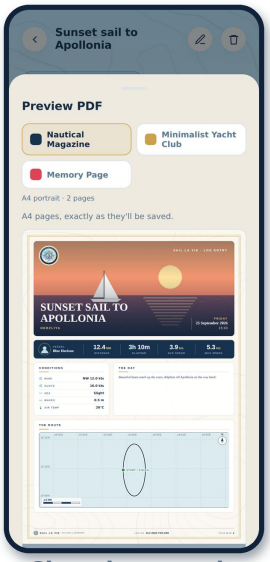
Minimalist Yacht Club



Memory Page

1. Open a sail and tap **Export as PDF** at the bottom of its page.
2. Choose a style: **Nautical Magazine**, **Minimalist Yacht Club** or **Memory Page**. The preview shows the real A4 pages, exactly as they'll be saved, and how many pages there are.
3. Tap the save / share button under the preview. On your phone you can send it to WhatsApp or email, or save it to your files.

Every photo on the sail is included once, all cropped to the same shape. Sails without a GPS track use the map image you added, if there is one.



Choosing a style

SECTION 10

Photo Gallery

Every photo from every sail in one place, grouped by date with the sail’s name next to it.



Photo Gallery

Open it from the **Gallery** tile on Home. Tap any photo to view it full screen, then swipe left or right to move through that sail’s photos, or pinch to zoom.

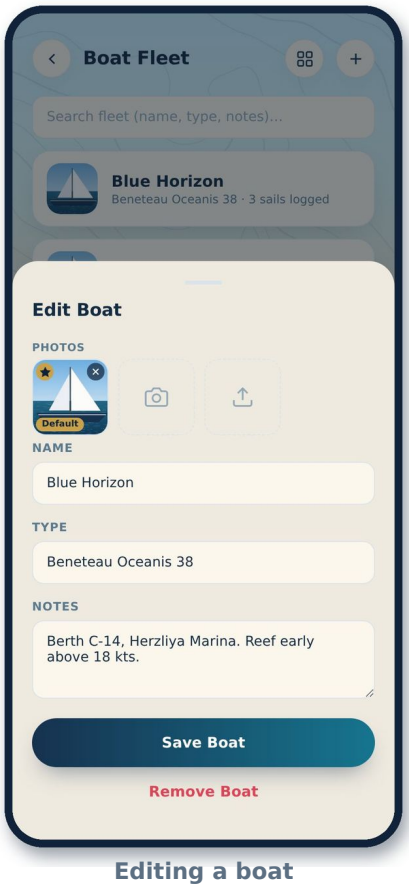
SECTION 11

Your Fleet (boats)

Keep a list of the boats you sail: your own, the club’s, or charters. Each shows how many sails you’ve logged on it.



Boat Fleet



Editing a boat

1. Tap **Fleet** in the bottom bar, then **+** at the top to add a boat.
2. Give it a name, type and notes, and add photos with the camera or upload buttons.
3. Tap **Save Boat**. Tap any boat later to edit it, or **Remove Boat** to delete it.

The grid icon next to **+** switches between a list and a grid of photos. Use the search box to find a boat by name, type or notes.

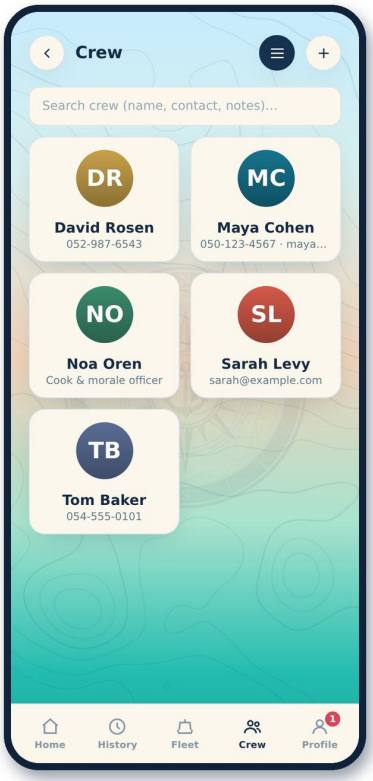
SECTION 12

Your Crew

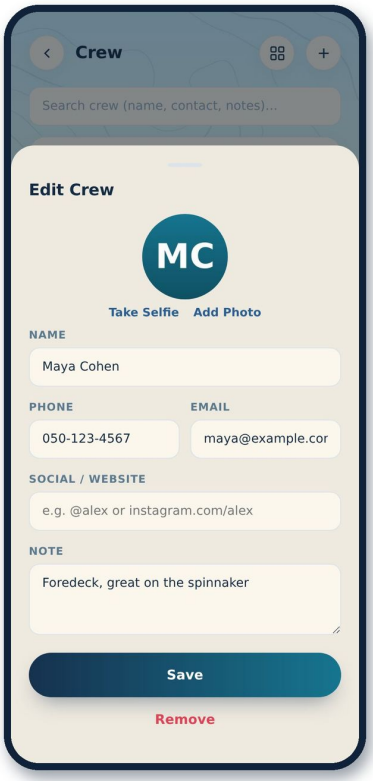
The people you sail with, with their contact details and a photo. Add them to a sail from the log screen.



Crew list



Grid view



Editing a crew member

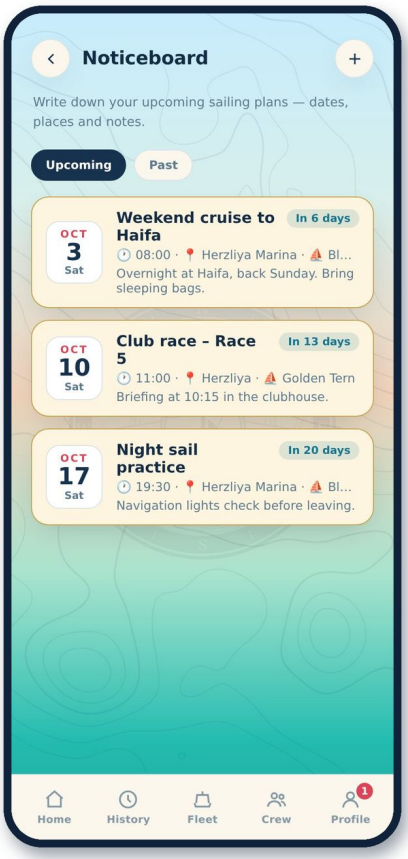
1. Tap **Crew** in the bottom bar, then **+**.
2. Add a name, phone, email, social link and a note (their role, for example). **Take Selfie** or **Add Photo** adds their picture.
3. Tap **Save**. Tap a person to edit them, or **Remove** to delete them.

> **Tip:** When logging a sail, use **Choose Skipper** and **+ Add Crew** in the Crew section to record who was aboard. Crew are your own records; to share sails with someone who also uses the app, add them as a friend (section 15).

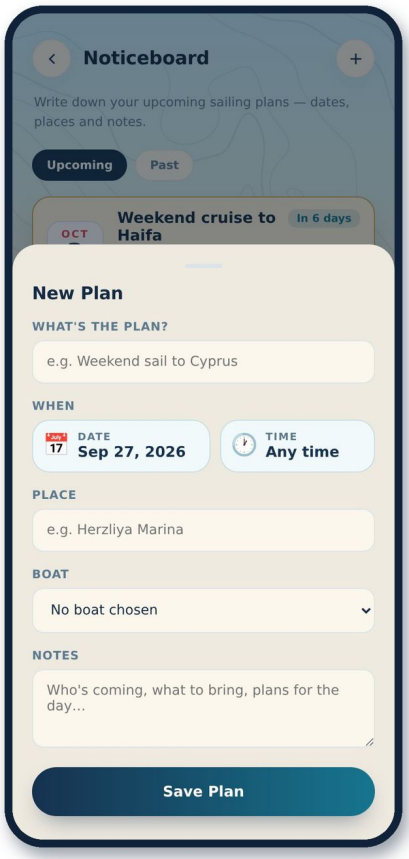
SECTION 13 · UPDATED

The Noticeboard (planned sails)

Write down upcoming sails so you and your crew know what’s coming: races, cruises, practice nights.



Upcoming plans



Adding a plan

1. Open the **Noticeboard** tile on Home and tap **+**.
2. Enter what’s planned, the date and (optionally) the time, the place, the boat and any notes.
3. Tap **Save Plan**.

Each plan shows a countdown such as “In 6 days”. Switch between **Upcoming** and **Past** with the chips at the top. Plans also appear in the Posts on your Profile. In the Android app you get a **reminder notification 24 hours before** each plan; tap it to open the Noticeboard.

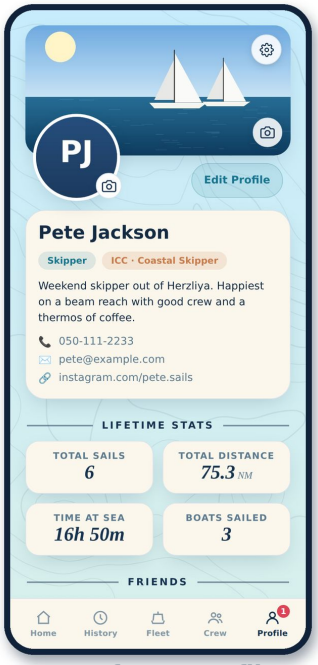
Sharing a plan with friends

When you save a new plan, the app asks who can see it, just like a sail: **Only me** or **Friends** (tapping outside counts as Only me). Your friends see your shared upcoming plans at the top of your page, and a **Shared** tag marks them in your list. To change it later, open the plan and tap the **Who can see this?** chip.

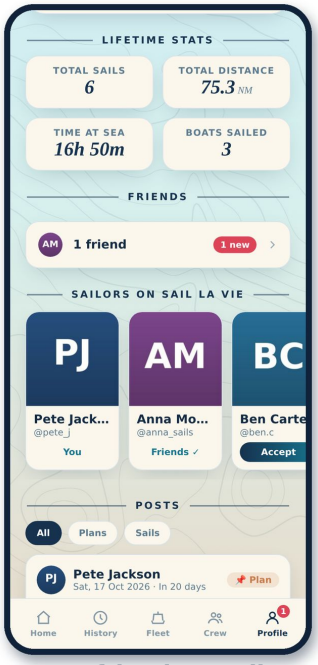
SECTION 14

Your Profile

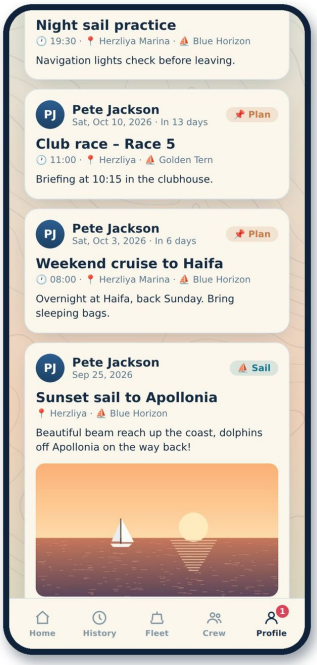
Your sailing page: a cover photo, your photo and details, lifetime stats, your friends, the other sailors on the app and a feed of your sails and plans.



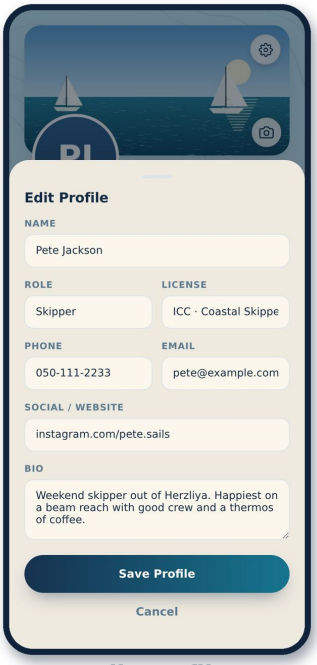
Top of your profile



Stats, friends & sailors



Your posts



Edit Profile

Tap the camera badges to change your cover photo or profile photo (tap the photos themselves to see them full size). **Edit Profile** sets your name, role, licence, contact details and a short bio.

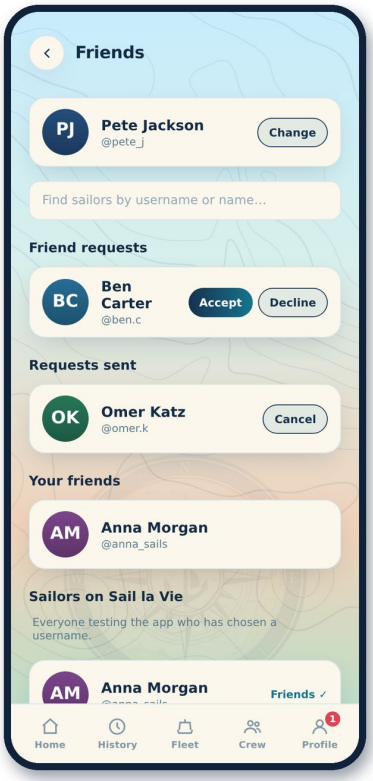
Further down you'll find your lifetime stats, your **Friends** card (with a red badge for new requests) and **Sailors on Sail la Vie**: a sideways-scrolling row of everyone testing the app. Swipe through it and tap a card to open that sailor's page, or use its **Add** or **Accept** button.

Posts shows every sail and plan, newest first. Filter them with **All**, **Plans** or **Sails**.

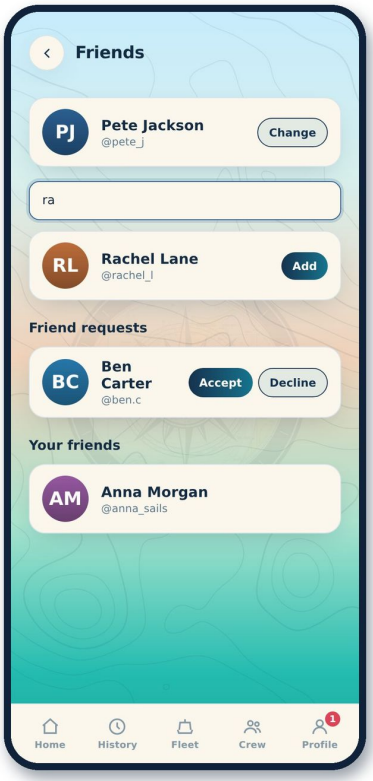
SECTION 15 · UPDATED

Friends

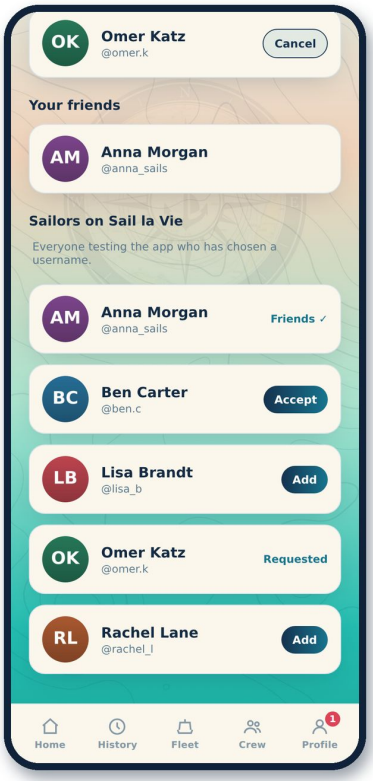
Add other Sail la Vie sailors as friends to see each other's shared sails. Friendships work both ways: one person sends a request and the other accepts it.



Friends screen



Searching



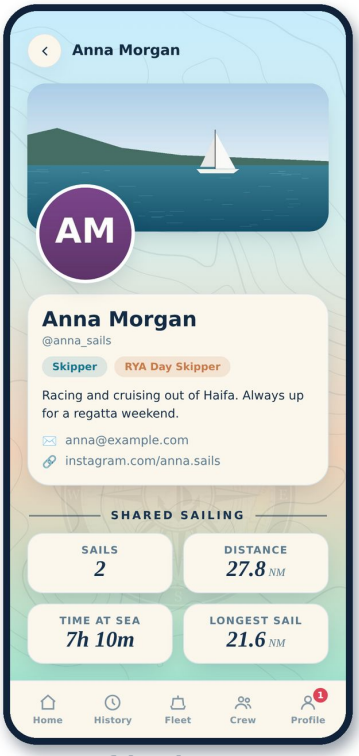
All sailors

Adding a friend

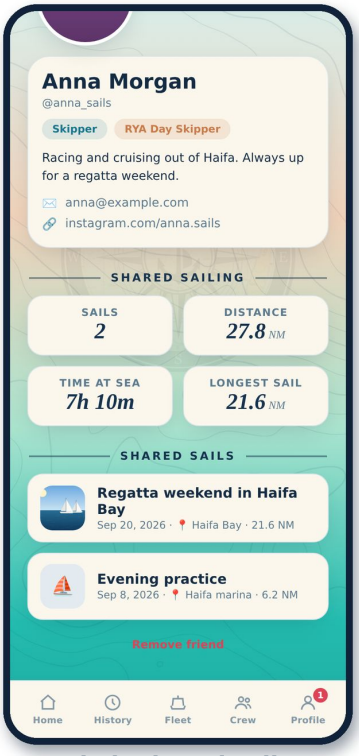
1. On your Profile, tap the **Friends** card.
2. Your username is at the top (you chose it when you first signed in). This is how other sailors find you. To change it, tap **Change**.
3. Type part of a sailor's username or name in the search box, or scroll down to **Sailors on Sail la Vie**, then tap **Add**.
4. They see your request under **Friend requests** and tap **Accept**. Requests arrive straight away, and the red badge on Profile tells you when one is waiting. You can **Cancel** a request you've sent, or **Decline** one you've received.

A friend’s page

Tap any sailor to open their page. A friend’s page looks like their own profile: photos, role, licence, bio, contact details and totals (**Shared sailing**), then their **Upcoming plans** and **Shared sails**. Tap a sail to open it: it looks like your own sail pages, with a “Shared by …” line at the top, but it’s read-only.



A friend’s page



Their shared sails



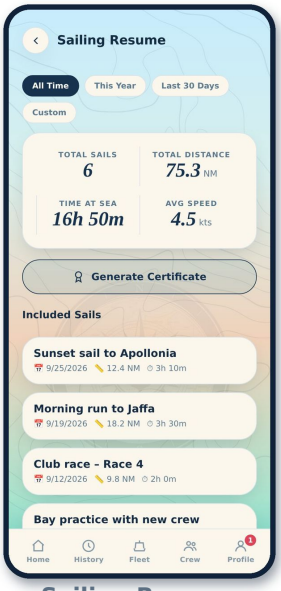
A shared sail

Tip: Someone who isn’t your friend yet only shows their name and photo, with an **Add friend** button. To remove a friend, open their page and tap **Remove friend** at the bottom. You’ll stop seeing each other’s shared sails.

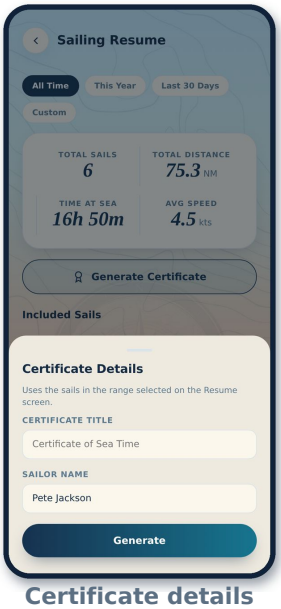
SECTION 16

Sailing Resume and certificate

A summary of your sailing experience, handy for courses, charters or joining a new crew.



Sailing Resume



Certificate details

Open the **Sailing Resume** tile on Home. Choose a period: **All Time**, **This Year**, **Last 30 Days** or **Custom** dates. You'll see the total sails, distance, time at sea and average speed, plus the list of sails included.

Certificate of Sea Time

1. Pick the period on the Resume screen, then tap **Generate Certificate**.
2. Give it a title (or keep "Certificate of Sea Time"), check the sailor name, and tap **Generate**.
3. Check the preview and tap **Save / Share PDF**.

The certificate is a one-page A4 landscape PDF with the Sail la Vie seal, your voyages, distance, time at sea, longest passage and the boats you sailed, plus its own certificate number and issue date.

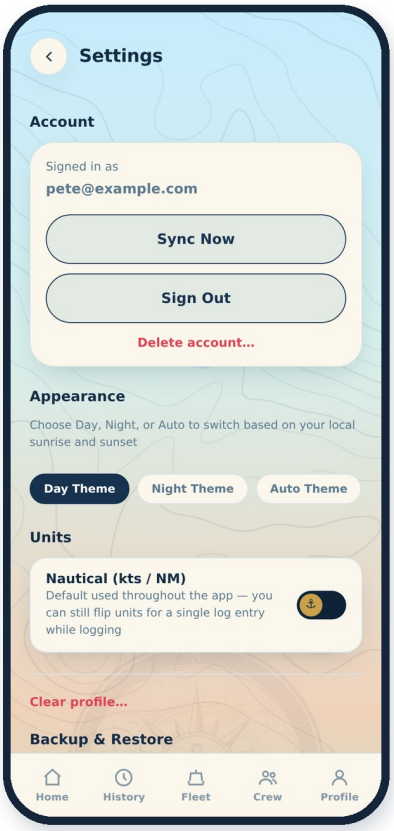


Certificate of Sea Time

SECTION 17

Settings, sync and backup

Open Settings from the gear icon on Home or on your Profile.



Account & appearance



Backup, help & reset

Account shows the email you're signed in with. **Sync Now** pulls in the latest changes straight away (normally this happens by itself: a change on one device appears on your others within moments), and **Sign Out** signs you out.

Appearance: choose **Day**, **Night**, or **Auto**, which switches with your local sunrise and sunset. **Units**: nautical (knots and nautical miles) or metric. You can also flip units for a single sail while logging it.

Backup & Restore saves everything to a file you can keep in Drive, iCloud or email, or move to a new phone. The **Danger Zone** erases everything on this device, so back up first.

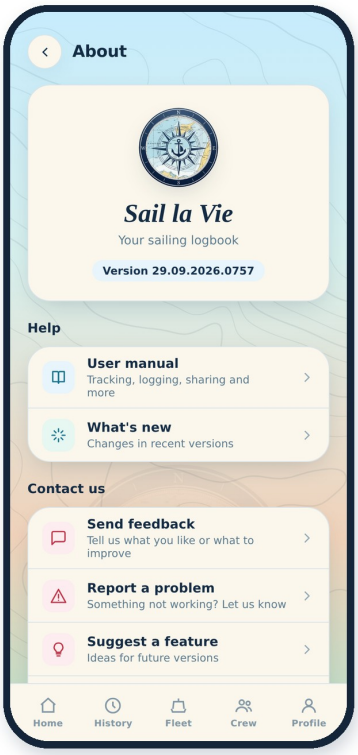
> **Tip:** At the very bottom of Settings is the app's **version number**. If something looks different from someone else's phone, compare version numbers first.

Help & About, just above the Danger Zone, has the **User manual**, **Contact us** and the **About** page with your version number and the legal information. See the next page.

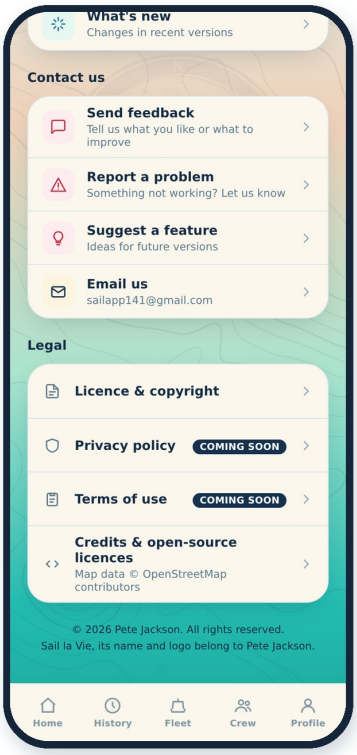
Delete account, the red link under Sign Out, permanently deletes your account and everything stored with it online: sails, photos, boats, crew, plans, profile and friends. You choose whether to keep a copy on this phone or erase it too, and you type **DELETE** to confirm. It can't be undone, so use **Backup to File** first if you want a copy.

Help & About

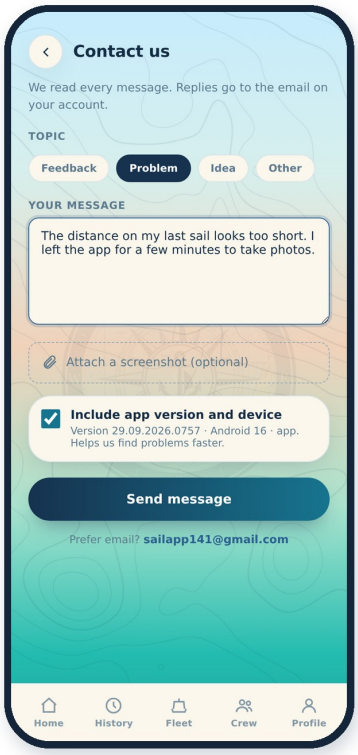
Open **Settings** and scroll to **Help & About**, just above the Danger Zone. From there you can open this guide, send us a message, and see the **About** page with your version number, what's new and the legal information.



The About page



Contact & legal



Sending a message

User manual

Tap **User manual** to open this guide. It always opens the latest edition, so there's nothing to download or update. You need a signal to open it.

Contact us

Tap **Send feedback**, **Report a problem** or **Suggest a feature**. Pick a topic, write your message and, if it helps, tap **Attach a screenshot**. Leave **Include app version and device** ticked so we know which version you have, then tap **Send message**. You need to be signed in to send a message. You can also email us at **sailapp141@gmail.com**.

Download for Android

On Android, the About page has **Download for Android**, which always downloads the newest version. When a new one is out, the app tells you with an **Update available** message, and this button changes to **Download the update**. Install it over the old one; your sails are kept.

About and legal

The **About** page shows your version number and **What's new** in recent versions. Under **Legal** you'll find the licence and copyright, the privacy policy, the terms of use, and credits for the maps, weather and software the app uses.

> **Tip:** Reporting a problem? Say what you were doing when it happened and attach a screenshot if you can. It helps us fix it much faster.

SECTION 18

iPhone and Android

Almost everything is the same on both. The big difference is how tracking behaves when your screen turns off.

	iPhone (web app)	Android (installed app)
How you get it	Safari → Share → **Add to Home Screen** (section 1).	Install the app file you were sent (section 1).
Tracking with the screen off	**No.** Tracking pauses when the screen locks or you switch to another app.	**Yes.** Keeps recording with the phone in your pocket.
Updates	Automatic. Close and reopen the app to get the latest version.	The app tells you when there's a new version. Tap **Download**, then **Install**.
Noticeboard reminders	Not available.	A notification 24 hours before each plan.
Everything else	The same: logging, photos, PDFs, boats, crew, friends and sync.	The same.

Tracking a sail on iPhone

1. **Before you cast off**, stop the screen locking: iPhone **Settings → Display & Brightness → Auto-Lock → Never**. Remember to set it back afterwards.
2. **Keep Sail la Vie open** on the log screen for the whole sail, and don't switch to other apps. Add photos from the Photos section inside the log and come straight back.
3. **Keep the phone charged.** A screen that stays on uses more battery, so bring a power bank or charge on board.
4. **Allow location** when asked. If you tapped Don't Allow, go to **Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services → Safari Websites**, choose **While Using the App** and turn on **Precise Location**.

> **If tracking stops:** If the app closes mid-sail, just reopen it: your journey carries on where it was. The time it was closed isn't tracked, so if the distance looks short afterwards, open the sail, tap the pencil and correct the duration and distance by hand.

Tracking a sail on Android

When asked for location, choose **While using the app**. Recording works with the screen off. For the most reliable tracking, also set the app's battery use to **Unrestricted** (**Settings → Apps → Sail la Vie → Battery**), and allow notifications if you'd like Noticeboard reminders.

SECTION 19

Handy tips

A few things that make logging easier.

Before you cast off

Allow location access when the app asks. On iPhone, keep the app open on the log screen for the whole sail (see section 18).

No signal at sea?

No problem. Tracking uses GPS, not mobile data. The track is drawn offline, photos are kept on your phone, and everything syncs when you're back in range.

Cover photos

When you save a sail with photos, you pick the cover and can crop it to fit. Change it later while editing with **Change Cover Photo**.

Up to 20 photos a sail

Choose your best shots. If you pick more than there's room for, the app adds as many as fit and tells you.

Past sails with no GPS

Add a photo of your chart or a screenshot from another app as the **map image**. It's used in the PDF too.

Sharing is your choice

Only sails marked **Friends** are visible to friends, and only to people you've accepted. Everything else stays private.

Several devices

Sign in with the same account on each one and your sails, photos, boats, crew, plans and profile stay in sync, live.

Something not right?

Go to **Settings → Help & About → Report a problem**. Your version number and device are added for you, and you can attach a screenshot.

Fair winds!